

2026 EDITION

PURDUE UNIVERSITY

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

West Lafayette, Indiana, USA

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1. Purdue at a Glance

#99
QS WORLD
RANKING

#51
US NEWS
RANKING

1869
FOUNDED

50,000+
TOTAL
STUDENTS

2,500+
INDIAN
STUDENTS

Attribute	Details
Full Name	Purdue University
Location	West Lafayette, Indiana, USA
Type	Public Research University
Acceptance Rate	53%
Student-Faculty Ratio	13:1
Graduation Rate	83%
International Students	22% of total enrollment
Gender Ratio	44:56 (Female:Male)
Website	purdue.edu
Nickname	"Cradle of Astronauts"

Famous Alumni

Neil Armstrong — First man on the moon (MS from Purdue)

Sundar Pichai — CEO of Google (worked at Purdue)

2. Why Choose Purdue?

- **Top 10 Engineering School** in the US at public university price
- **More astronauts than any other university** — NASA's favorite recruitment ground
- **2,500+ Indian students** with a strong, tight-knit STEM community
- **Affordable tuition** for the quality offered — best ROI among top engineering schools
- **World's largest academic propulsion lab** — Zucrow Labs
- **Strong industry recruiting** from Boeing, Lockheed Martin, SpaceX, Amazon, and more
- **Safe, affordable college town** — West Lafayette is built around students
- **91% placement rate** within 6 months of graduation

Insider Tip

Purdue is known as the "Poor Man's MIT" — offering comparable engineering quality at a fraction of the cost. If you're an Indian student with a strong STEM background and a tight budget, Purdue should be at the top of your list.

3. Programs & Courses

3.1 Popular Master's Programs for Indian Students

Program		Duration	Tuition/Year	Key Highlights
MS Aerospace Engineering		2 Years	\$18K-22K	World's #1 aerospace program. Wind tunnel and propulsion labs. NASA-funded research.
MS Computer Science		2 Years	\$18K-22K	Strong in systems, AI, and software engineering. Top recruiters: Amazon, Google, Microsoft.
MS Mechanical Engineering		2 Years	\$18K-22K	Automotive, robotics, and thermal systems. Strong industry connections.

Program Requirements

Requirement	MS Aerospace	MS CS	MS Mechanical
Bachelor's Degree	Aero/Mech (70%+)	CS (70%+)	Mechanical (70%+)
GRE Score	315+	310+	305+
IELTS	6.5+	6.5+	6.5+
Work Experience	Not required	Not required	Not required
Intakes	Fall, Spring	Fall, Spring	Fall, Spring

Other Available Programs

Purdue also offers strong programs in Electrical & Computer Engineering, Civil Engineering, Industrial Engineering, Data Science, Business Analytics, and an MBA through the Krannert School of Management. Check the official Purdue Graduate School website for the complete program directory.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

4.1 Admission Requirements

Requirement	Minimum	Competitive
GPA (10-point scale)	7.0+	8.0+
GRE	305+	315+ (Aero: 320+)
IELTS	6.5 overall	7.0+
TOEFL iBT	80+	100+
Work Experience	Not required for MS programs	
LORs	3 Letters of Recommendation	
SOP	Required	
Resume/CV	Required	
Interview	Not required	
Application Fee	\$75 (approx Rs 6,250)	

Standardized Test Details

GRE: Verbal (130-170) + Quantitative (130-170) + AWA (0-6). Total 305+ recommended. 315+ makes you competitive. For Aerospace Engineering, aim for 320+. GRE is valid for 5 years. Fee: \$220 (approx Rs 18,500).

IELTS: Listening, Reading, Writing, Speaking — each scored 0-9. Overall 6.5 minimum, 7.0+ recommended. Valid for 2 years. Fee: Rs 16,250.

Required Documents

[] 10th & 12th Mark Sheets and Certificates

[] Bachelor's Degree Certificate

[] All Semester Mark Sheets / Transcript

[] GRE Score Card

[] IELTS / TOEFL Score Card

[] Passport (valid for 6+ months)

[] Statement of Purpose (SOP)

4. Eligibility & Requirements

[] 3 Letters of Recommendation (LOR)

[] Resume / CV

[] Financial Proof (\$45,000+ in bank)

[] Application Fee Receipt (\$75)

[] Backlog Certificate (if applicable)

Important: Purdue requires proof of funds showing at least \$45,000 (approx Rs 37.5 Lakhs) for the first year. This can be a bank statement, education loan sanction letter, or sponsor letter.

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Application Deadline	Decision Date	Classes Begin
Fall (Primary)	January 1	March 15	August
Spring	September 1	October 15	January

Pro Tip

Apply for Fall intake. Fall is the primary intake with more seats, more funding opportunities, and better assistantship chances. Spring intake has limited seats and fewer scholarship options. Submit your application by **December 1** to be safe — don't wait until the January 1 deadline.

Application Process

1. Create an account on the **Purdue Graduate School Application Portal**
2. Select your program (Aerospace, CS, Mechanical, etc.)
3. Fill in personal and academic details
4. Upload all required documents (transcripts, SOP, LORs, resume)
5. Report GRE and IELTS scores (use Purdue's institution code: **1631**)
6. Pay the \$75 application fee
7. Submit and track your application status online

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

6.1 Detailed Budget Breakdown (Per Year)

Expense Category	Cost (USD)	Cost (INR approx.)
Tuition (MS)	\$18,000 - 22,000	Rs 15 - 18.5 Lakhs
Accommodation	\$7,000 - 12,000	Rs 5.8 - 10 Lakhs
Food	\$3,000 - 5,000	Rs 2.5 - 4.2 Lakhs
Transport	\$1,000	Rs 83,000
Health Insurance	\$2,500	Rs 2.1 Lakhs
Personal / Books	\$2,500 - 4,000	Rs 2.1 - 3.3 Lakhs
TOTAL PER YEAR	\$34,000 - 46,500	Rs 28 - 39 Lakhs

Total 2-Year MS Budget

Component	Amount (INR)
Year 1 (Tuition + Living)	Rs 28 - 39 Lakhs
Year 2 (Tuition + Living)	Rs 28 - 39 Lakhs
One-time costs (flight, visa, tests)	Rs 2 - 3 Lakhs
GRAND TOTAL (2 Years)	Rs 58 - 81 Lakhs

Cost-Saving Tips

- **Graduate Assistantship:** Covers full tuition + \$1,500-2,500/month stipend. Apply with your admission.
- **Part-time work:** 20 hrs/week on campus. Earn \$800-1,200/month.
- **Summer internship:** CPT allows paid internships. Average: \$5,000-8,000/month.
- **Shared accommodation:** Sharing an apartment reduces rent by 40-50%.
- **Cook your own food:** Indian groceries available. Cooking saves \$200-300/month.

ROI Calculation (MS CS Example)

Total Investment: Rs 70 Lakhs (2 years)
Starting Salary: \$115,000/year (Rs 95 Lakhs/year)

Breakeven Period: ~1 year of work

5-Year Net Gain: Rs 3-4 Crores (after taxes and expenses)

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship	Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
Purdue Engineering Fellowship	\$5,000 - 15,000/yr	Strong background	STEM Jan 1
Graduate School Merit Award	\$3,000 - 10,000/yr	GPA 8.0+	Rolling
Graduate (TA/RA) Assistantship	Full tuition + \$1,500-2,500/mo	Research/Teaching skills	With admission
Fulbright-Nehru Scholarship	Full funding	3+ years work experience	June-July

Maximizing Your Funding

The best way to fund your Purdue education is through a **Graduate Assistantship**. It covers your full tuition and gives you a monthly stipend. To improve your chances: maintain a high GPA, gain research experience, connect with professors before applying, and highlight any teaching or research experience in your SOP.

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

8.1 Placement Statistics (2024 Data)

91%

PLACEMENT RATE (6 MONTHS)

\$98K

AVERAGE SALARY

\$190K

HIGHEST SALARY

900+

RECRUITING COMPANIES

Course-Wise Placement Data

Program	Placement Rate	Avg Salary	Top Roles
MS Aerospace	94%	\$105,000	Aerospace Engineer, Propulsion Engineer, Flight Test Engineer, CFD Analyst
MS Computer Science	93%	\$115,000	Software Engineer, Systems Architect, ML Engineer
MS Mechanical	88%	\$92,000	Design Engineer, Manufacturing Engineer, Thermal Engineer, R&D Engineer

Top Recruiting Companies

Boeing, NASA, SpaceX, Amazon, Caterpillar, Deloitte, Rolls-Royce, Lockheed Martin, General Electric, Raytheon, Google, Microsoft, Apple, Tesla, Northrop Grumman

Post-Study Work Visa (USA)

Stage	Duration	Details
OPT (Standard)	12 months	Work permit after graduation
STEM OPT Extension	+24 months	Available for all 3 programs (Aerospace, CS, Mechanical are STEM)
Total Work Time	36 months	3 full years to work and find H-1B sponsorship
H-1B Visa	3+3 years	Employer-sponsored work visa
Green Card	Permanent	Long-term pathway through employment

H-1B Lottery: The H-1B visa is awarded through a lottery system with roughly 25-30% selection odds. Having 3 years of OPT (STEM extension) gives you 3 attempts at the lottery, significantly improving your chances.

9. Campus Life for Indians

9.1 Living at Purdue

Accommodation

Type	Cost/Month	Pros	Cons
On-campus Dorms	\$600-900	Close to classes, meal plans	Limited availability for grad students
Off-campus Apartments	\$500-800	More space, cheaper with roommates	Need to arrange utilities
Shared Houses	\$400-600	Cheapest option, Indian community	Farther from campus

Indian Food & Groceries

West Lafayette has excellent Indian food options: **Chaat House**, **Bombay Cafe**, **India Mahal**. For groceries, **Patel Brothers** stocks all Indian spices, lentils, and snacks. Many Indian students cook together and share meals.

Indian Student Community

- **Purdue Indian Students Association (ISA)** — 500+ members, organizes all major Indian festivals
- **Bharati** — Indian classical dance and music group
- **Purdue Cricket Club** — Regular matches and tournaments
- **Hindi Cinema Club** — Bollywood movie nights

Festivals Celebrated

India Night, Diwali, Holi, Garba — All major Indian festivals are celebrated on campus with hundreds of attendees. India Night is the biggest event, featuring Bollywood dances, Indian food stalls, and cultural performances.

Weather

Winter: -10°C to 5°C (Nov-Mar) — Very cold, snow common. Buy a heavy winter jacket.

Summer: 20°C to 30°C (Jun-Aug) — Warm and pleasant.

Tip: Indian students often struggle with the first winter. Invest in good winter gear before you arrive.

Safety

West Lafayette is a **very safe college town** with low crime rates. The campus is well-lit and has a 24/7 security patrol. Purdue also offers a safe ride service for late-night travel.

Weekend Getaways

- **Indianapolis** — 1 hour drive. State capital, good shopping and dining.
- **Chicago** — 2 hours drive. Major city, Indian grocery hub, airport.
- **Indiana Dunes National Park** — 1.5 hours. Beautiful lakeside beaches.

10. Application Checklist

Before You Apply (3-6 months prior)

- ☐ Take GRE and aim for 310+ (315+ for Aerospace)
- ☐ Take IELTS and aim for 7.0+
- ☐ Request transcripts from your university
- ☐ Get 3 LORs from professors/employers
- ☐ Draft your Statement of Purpose (SOP)
- ☐ Prepare your Resume/CV
- ☐ Arrange financial documents (\$45K+ proof)

Application Steps

- ☐ Visit purdue.edu/gradschool and create an account
- ☐ Select your program (Aerospace / CS / Mechanical)
- ☐ Fill in all personal and academic details
- ☐ Upload transcripts, SOP, LORs, and resume
- ☐ Send GRE scores (code: 1631) and IELTS scores
- ☐ Pay \$75 application fee
- ☐ Submit application before January 1 (Fall) or September 1 (Spring)
- ☐ Track application status online

After Acceptance

- ☐ Accept offer and pay enrollment deposit
- ☐ Apply for I-20 (Certificate of Eligibility)
- ☐ Pay SEVIS fee (\$350)
- ☐ Schedule F-1 visa interview at US Embassy
- ☐ Prepare visa documents (I-20, financial proof, SOP)
- ☐ Attend visa interview

10. Application Checklist

☐ Book flight tickets

☐ Arrange temporary accommodation

☐ Attend Purdue orientation (mandatory)

Visa Wait Times: US visa interview appointments in India can have wait times of 3-6 months. Book your appointment as soon as you receive your I-20. Do not delay.

11. What Purdue Students Say

"I touched a rocket engine in my first semester. Where else does that happen? The hands-on experience here is unreal. I got placed at Boeing within 3 months of graduating."

— Akash, MS Aerospace Engineering '24

"Purdue football games are electric. 50,000 people chanting 'Boiler Up!' — gives you goosebumps every time. The Indian community here is like family."

— Riya, MS Mechanical Engineering '25

"The engineering community here is like a family. Everyone helps everyone. No cutthroat competition. My professors actually know my name and care about my progress."

— Varun, MS Computer Science '24

Ready to Apply to Purdue?

Let Kohortconnect help you craft a winning application. Our verified consultants specialize in Purdue admissions and can help with SOP writing, LOR guidance, and interview preparation.

Visit www.kohortconnect.com or WhatsApp us to get your personalized Purdue admission roadmap.

Boiler Up!

Your Purdue Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your Purdue application — SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more. Chat with us on WhatsApp.

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